

The 2026 Shubhra Kar Linux Foundation Training (LiFT) SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM COPY

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Applicant Information

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Unique Apps:

Name & Basic Information

Name and Basic Information

First Name:	Lydia
Middle Name or Initial:	A
Last Name:	Morgan
How old are you?	40
What city do you live in?	Galway
What State/Province do you live in?	None
What country do you live in?	Ireland
Please upload a headshot of yourself.	20260326_152125.jpg
Please provide a link to your LinkedIn profile, if you have one.	https://www.linkedin.com/in/lydia-morgan-a75951375?utm_source=share&utm_campaign=share_via&utm_content=profile&utm_medium=android_app
Please provide a link to your GitHub account, if you have one.	https://www.github.com/lydiamorgan85

Permissions

By checking YES below you agree that by submitting this application you consent to be interviewed, photographed and/or video recorded about your experience with the Linux Foundation for publicity purposes.	Yes
By checking YES below you agree that by submitting this application you give consent to receive marketing information from the Linux Foundation and Linux Foundation Training & Certification.	Yes
By checking YES below you agree that by submitting this application you consent to be interviewed, photographed and/or video recorded about your experience with the Linux Foundation for publicity purposes.	Yes
By checking YES below you acknowledge that only individuals and not organizations or groups, formally or informally organized, may apply for a LiFT Scholarship.	Yes

Employment & Education

Employment and Education

What is your employment status?	Unemployed IT Professional
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What is your job title or area of study? If you are an unemployed IT professional, please provide your most recent IT-related job title.	Software engineering
What is the name of your employer or school? If you are an unemployed IT professional please provide the name of your most recent IT-related employer.	Mgc derma
Street Address:	Keelogue Meelick Eyrecourt
City:	Galway
State/Province:	None
Country:	Ireland
How many years experience do you have as an IT professional?	1 to 3 Years
Do you volunteer as an IT professional for a community based organization or NGO (non-governmental organization)?	No

Technology & Learning

Technology and Learning

What area(s) of open source do you want to learn about next? Why? (Maximum point value: 20 points)

Honestly, Kubernetes felt like the obvious next step for me. I've been working with Docker and containerisation, and once you start building anything real with containers, you hit this wall where you go "right, how do I actually manage all of these in production?" That's basically what Kubernetes solves. I wanted to understand how applications get scaled, how they recover when something breaks, how you do rolling updates without taking a service down. That's all Kubernetes territory. And nearly every company I've looked at that's doing cloud native work is using it in some form. It's kind of the industry standard at this point. What drew me to it specifically is that it ties together so much of what I've already been learning. My Docker knowledge feeds directly into it. My cloud cert work on Azure, AWS, and GCP, they all have managed Kubernetes services. Terraform, which I've been using, can provision Kubernetes clusters. So it's not a random thing I picked off a list, it's genuinely the piece that connects everything else together. I'm also interested in it from a sustainability angle. Kubernetes lets you be smarter about resource allocation. You're not just throwing servers at a problem, you're letting the orchestrator figure out what's actually needed. That appeals to me because I care about the environmental side of infrastructure, not just the technical side. I'm still learning it, I'm not going to pretend I'm an expert, but I understand the core concepts like pods, deployments, services, namespaces, and I've been getting hands on with local clusters.

Describe your experience using and developing open source software or technology. (Maximum point value: 20 points).

So my experience with open source is quite hands on The biggest example is CodeShield AI which is a security scanner I built and published on GitHub Marketplace It's a live product with Pro and Team pricing tiers so its not just a hobby project sitting in a repo I built that using Python and GitHub Actions and putting something on a public marketplace where other developers rely on it taught me a lot about documentation versioning and making sure your CI CD pipeline is solid Beyond that my whole tech stack is basically open source Docker for containerisation Terraform for infrastructure as code React on the frontend Python on the backend I use VS Code every day I've been doing the CS50 Python course from Harvard and I'm working through Docker training on KodeKloud Everything I'm learning with is built on open source tooling I'm also doing cloud certifications across Azure AWS and GCP and a huge amount of what runs on those platforms is open source under the hood Kubernetes Linux all of that I've been writing GitHub Actions workflows to automate testing and deployment which is built on open source What I find exciting about open source is that its not gatekept I come from a non traditional background I didn't do a computer science degree originally so open source was how I got access to enterprise grade tools and learned how real infrastructure actually works without needing someone to hand me a licence.

Why is learning more about open source technology important to your future? (Maximum point value: 20 points).

Open source is basically the foundation of everything I want to do with my career. I'm moving into cloud engineering and DevOps and the reality is that almost everything in that space runs on open source. Linux, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, the list goes on. If you don't understand open source you're going to struggle in this field, its as simple as that. For me personally its bigger than just career stuff though. I came into tech from a non traditional route. I didn't have a computer science degree or connections in the industry, and open source is what gave me a way in. I could learn on real tools, build real projects, and put my work out there for anyone to see. I built CodeShield AI and put it on GitHub Marketplace and that opened doors that a qualification alone wouldn't have. Open source let me prove what I can do rather than just talk about it. Going forward I want to specialise in making cloud infrastructure more sustainable and reducing the environmental impact of how we build and run technology. That work is going to happen in open source communities because thats where the innovation is and thats where people collaborate openly on hard problems. I want to be part of that.

Scholarship Categories

Scholarship Categories

Carefully review the following categories and select the one that best matches to you. Select carefully as your choice will lead you to a final essay question for the scholarship application based on your selection. This is the most important question in your application with a maximum point value of 40 points.

AI written answers, along with answers copied from someone else will significantly lower your score and risk. Answers that show originality and personal input will increase your score. Spelling, grammar and punctuation errors will not affect your score.

Woman in Open Source

Open Source Newbie: I am a full-time college student studying to be an IT professional taking at least 4 college-level classes per semester or an IT professional with less than two years experience and I have learned the basics and am looking to continue to expand my open source knowledge and skills through additional training and ...

How will training & certification help you, and other women, to work and participate in the open source technology community? (Maximum point value: 40 points).

Training and certification gives you something concrete to stand on When you walk into a room or a conversation in open source and you're a woman theres often this unspoken expectation that you have to prove yourself more than everyone else Having certifications doesn't make you a better engineer on its own but it does give you credibility that people cant dismiss It says I know what I'm talking about and heres the proof For me the training side has been massive Every certification I've worked through whether its Azure AWS Docker or cloud engineering has given me confidence to contribute and speak up in spaces where I might have held back before And confidence is honestly half the battle I've seen so many women who are brilliant but they don't put themselves forward because they feel like they're not ready yet Training helps close that gap between what you know and what you believe you know The other thing is that when women get certified and visible in open source it creates a knock on effect I run a womens circle and I've seen firsthand how powerful it is when someone sees another woman doing something and thinks ok maybe I can do that too Every woman who gets trained and starts contributing to open source makes it a little bit easier for the next one Representation matters and its not just a nice thing to say its actually true I want to be someone who brings other women into this space with me Getting properly trained and certified is how I make sure I can do that from a position of real knowledge.
